

The Millers always had approached money as a taboo subject. It was very uncomfortable for them to talk about the family finances. They assumed that Rebecca had learned about money in school. Unfortunately, no personal finance course existed in her school's curriculum. Since Rebecca had never heard her parents discuss the household expenses, she had no concept of mortgage payments or utility bills.

Many times, parents that are better off financially demand the least from their adult nesters. They might never dream to charge them room and board. But by living in an unreal situation with no bills or financial responsibilities, their children are the least equipped to handle themselves once they enter the real world. A mother once told me that she kept raising the rent she charged her daughter who had moved back in after college. When the rent got high enough, her daughter found her own place. With increased education and responsibility, the incidents of returning to the nest or staying in the nest will be reduced dramatically.

Big City Living

Moving out for the first time is difficult. It becomes even more challenging when you need to live in a large city. Most large cities are expensive places to live. A starting salary of \$25,000 might allow you to enjoy a life of relative comfort while living with your parents. However, on your own, this salary may barely cover rent and food.

Reginald knew the financial realities of moving to Washington, D.C. He had done his research and a complete budget. The bottom line told him that it would be very difficult to afford the move on his starting salary of \$27,500 as a low-level staffer on the Hill. Reginald, at twenty-two, had just graduated from Penn State University and had moved back to his parents' house in Maryland.

